head down, stay at home. I was profoundly moved, humbled, by this quiet display of courage.

Across the line from S.A.R. Geelani, in the jostling crowd of journalists and photographers, trying his best to look inconspicuous in a lemon T-shirt and gaberdine pants, holding a little tape-recorder, was another Gilani. Iftikhar Gilani. He had been in prison too. He was arrested and taken into police custody on 9 June 2002. At the time he was a reporter for the Jammu-based *Kashmir Times*. He was charged under the Official Secrets Act. His 'crime' was that he supposedly possessed information on Indian troop deployment in 'Indian held Kashmir'. (This 'information', it turns out, was a published monograph by a Pakistani research institute, and was freely available on the Internet for anybody who wished to download it.) Iftikhar Gilani's computer was seized. IB officials tampered with his hard drive, meddled with the downloaded file, changed the words 'Indian-held Kashmir' to 'Jammu and Kashmir' to make it sound like an Indian document, and added the words 'Only for Reference. Strictly Not for Circulation', to make it seem like a secret document smuggled out of the Home Ministry. The Directorate General of Military Intelligence—though it had been given a photocopy of the monograph—ignored repeated appeals from Iftikhar Gilani's counsel, kept quiet, and refused to clarify the matter for a whole six months.

Once again the malicious lies put out by the Special Cell were obediently reproduced in the newspapers. Here are a few of the lies they told:

'Iftikhar Gilani, 35-year-old son-in-law of Hurriyat hardliner Syed Ali Shah Gilani is believed to have admitted in a city court that he was an agent of Pakistan's spy agency.' (*Hindustan Times*)[11]

'Iftikhar Gilani was the pin-point man of Syed Salahuddin of Hizbul Mujahideen. Investigations have revealed that Iftikhar used to pass information to Salahuddin about the moves of Indian security agencies. He had camouflaged his real motives behind his journalist's façade so well that it took years to unmask him, well-placed sources said.' (*Pioneer*)[12]

'Gilani ke daamaad ke ghar aaykar chhaapon mein behisaab sampati wa samwaidansheil dastaweiz baraamad.' (Translation: 'Enormous wealth and sensitive documents recovered from the house of Gilani's son-in- law during Income-tax raids.') (*Hindustan*)[13]

Never mind that the police charge sheet recorded a recovery of only Rs 3,450 from his house. Meanwhile, other media reports said that he had a three-bedroom flat, an undisclosed income of Rs 22 lakhs, had evaded